Harvest Sanitation Log: How to Use It

Handout for growers. Keep this sheet in the pack shed.

Why keep a log

A written log shows a buyer or an auditor that harvest containers and food contact surfaces are cleaned and sanitized on a schedule, not only when they look dirty.

What to record each day

1. Date and the name of the person who did the work.
2. Each surface or container cleaned, such as harvest bins, knives, wash tanks and the packing table.
3. The sanitizer used and its concentration, checked with a test strip, in parts per million (ppm).
4. Any problem you found and what you did about it.

Common mistakes

Sanitizing a surface that was never cleaned. Soil and plant debris use up the sanitizer before it can work.
Mixing sanitizer by guesswork instead of following the label. Too weak does not kill pathogens; too strong can harm produce and workers.
Filling in the log at the end of the week from memory.

Keep records for two years

Store completed logs in a binder or a shared folder. Review them once a month and look for gaps or repeated problems at the same station.